

Workshop

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Of broken heatsink fans, processor upgrade dilemmas, And more...

It's Team Digit to the rescue.

Q Laptop safety concerns

Sir, I am a student and currently staying in a hostel. My friend recently bought a Lenovo Y510p and it was stolen. Sir, I own an Asus G56JR- CN135H laptop and I'm worried about it. Sir, is there any way to track down my laptop if it is ever stolen? Are any tracker devices available for this purpose? Please do reply soon sir.

– Ankit Mishra



A Kensington lock is a tool to secure a laptop.

A Hey Ankit, there were way too many 'Sir(s)' for us in your query. Coming to your tracking solution, there are plenty of software available in the market to help track your laptop. Prey is one such software that is quite popular and has apps for multiple mobile platforms. Unfortunately, all of these require an internet connection for you to do anything remotely in case of a theft. So that's one step towards securing your laptop. Another thing you can do is keep your laptop safe in a steel cupboard or anything similar. Investing in a Kensington lock would also help since the thief would have to cause physical damage to the device in order to steal it. Or the thief could simply go to YouTube and find a video to unlatch

the lock without causing any damage. These methods serve to inhibit a crook but a determined burglar will manage to steal your device. At the end of the day, the thief will go for an easy job so you can expect your laptop to remain untouched if you do get a physical lock.

Q Will Potter run on my PC?

My system configuration is Intel C2D E8400 @3GHz, 4GB RAM, motherboard is Asus P5G41T-M LX3 running Windows XP. I want to play Harry potter game series so I want a decent graphics card for this system. Please suggest one, also can I upgrade to win7. Thanks in advance. With regards,

– Suresh Babu

A Dear Suresh,

We're guessing you want to play the latest game in the series, namely Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 2. The system requirements for this particular game are as follows.

- CPU - 2.4 GHz Single Core / 2.0 GHz Dual Core
- RAM - 1.5 GB
- OS - Win XP SP3/Vista SP2/7
- Disc space - 9 GB
- GPU - 256MB DX9 capable, Geforce 6800/Radeon X1600 or better.

What you haven't mentioned is what resolution you wish to run the game on or what your budget is. If you are on a low budget then you can get any graphics card which starts at Rs.2,000 and run the game on 800x600 resolution. Or you can go for a GTX 750 which should cost Rs.9,000+ and run this particular game at full HD and most games released these days at Full HD with minimal settings. We need to know more to suggest a proper card. As for your other query, yes you can

install Windows 7 on your machine, your motherboard's vendor has listed Windows 7 drivers for your motherboard. You can check it out here: <http://digit.in/P5G41T>

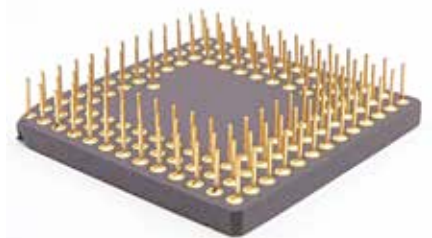
Q Laptop processor upgrade

Hello,

I'm using a Lenovo G500s model laptop having 3rd Generation Core i3-3110M processor, rPGA socket. Is it possible to upgrade the processor to Core i5 of the same generation and where can I get the processor if possible, I really need it.

– Subham Sharma

A Hey Subham, Yes it is possible to upgrade laptop processors. The difficulty in doing so depends upon availability of the processors, the complexity of the laptop chassis assembly and most importantly the socket used. You've mentioned that your processor is using an rPGA socket, this stands for Reversed Pin Grid Array, it is one of the socket technologies that Intel uses for mobile processors; the other being FCBGA or Flip Chip Ball



A typical rPGA socket based processor.

Grid Array. The former is easy to replace but the latter requires specialised tools which can desolder a BGA chip and replace it. So you've got it easy in your case. Now what you need to worry about is your TDP, the cooling system in your laptop is designed based on the TDP or Thermal Design Power of your processor,